PdfHelperReader

Simple user tutorial — offline dual-pane reading with a built-in vocabulary sidecar.

Quick Reference: Top Ribbon Buttons

Button	What it does
OB	Open Book — pick a PDF from your device
S	Cycle layout: Both / Book Only / Vocab Only
Z	Enter Zen Mode (distraction-free reading)
O	Run OCR on a scanned book
T	Toggle dark mode
H	Reading history (last 50 books)
B / BL	Add a bookmark / view bookmark list

1. Opening a Book & Vocabulary Sidecar

- Tap **OB** in the top ribbon and pick any PDF book from your device.
- The app checks Downloads/PdfHelperReader_files/ for a file named {bookName}_vocab.pdf. If found, it opens instantly side-by-side with your book.

2. Smart Vocabulary Generation

- No sidecar found? Tap **Generate Vocab PDF**.
- Common English words are filtered out; complex or foreign terms are matched against a WordNet dictionary (77,500+ definitions).
- If the vocab file already exists, it opens immediately — no duplicate work.

> **Tip:** Generate once per book. Next time you open it, the vocab pane appears automatically.

3. Navigation & Gestures

Gesture / Control	Action
Double-tap **right side** of a page	Next page
Double-tap **left side** of a page	Previous page
Pinch with two fingers	Zoom up to 5x; drag to pan when zoomed in
- / **%** / **+** in pane header	Precise zoom adjustment

> **Note:** The Book pane and Vocab pane work **independently** — turning a page in one doesn't affect the other.

4. Layout Modes (S Button)

Tap **S** to cycle through three modes:

Mode	View
Both	Dual-pane: side-by-side in landscape, top-and-bottom in portrait
Book Only	Full-screen primary book reader
Vocab Only	Full-screen vocabulary sidecar

5. Immersive Zen Mode (Z Button)

- Tap **Z** for pure, distraction-free reading — all menus and headers are hidden.
- **Page badge:** each document shows its current page number (e.g. 24) in the top-right corner.
- **Floating controls** (bottom-right): **B** bookmarks your current position; **Exit Zen** returns to normal mode.

6. OCR for Scanned Books (O Button)

- Open a scanned (image-based) PDF where text can't be selected, then tap **O**.
- After a confirmation prompt, on-device OCR (Google ML Kit) adds a selectable, searchable text layer.
- A new searchable PDF is saved to Downloads/PdfHelperReader_files/.

> **Note:** OCR runs entirely on your device, so it can take a while on long books.

7. Dark Mode, History & Bookmarks

- **T** — toggles dark mode by inverting PDF colours with a GPU colour matrix (fast and smooth).
- **H** — shows your reading history (last 50 opened books).
- **B / BL** — add a bookmark, and open your saved bookmark list.